



Joseph: Black and African American inclusion in the data industry

Hello, my name is Joseph. I'm a people analyst at Google. As a people analyst, my job is to work with executives and HR business partners to use data to make informed people decisions. **Inclusion** is very essential to the work that we do. As you know, sometimes you can start with data and have your own bias in it. For us in this field that is very sensitive, it requires that we have a diverse set of people who have different backgrounds to have this lens of data to work. Being a black professional, I can better tell a story about people of color that is a lot more personal to me.

Being an analyst requires me to take data and tell a story with it. On a personal standpoint, I'm very passionate about this space of increasing representation in the tech industry. For example, outside of work, I run a nonprofit called Sankofa Tech. Our whole goal is essentially to help develop the next generation of black engineers who can essentially be in this field and represent our experience using data as a foundation and offer technology as the powering moving factor going forward. It's critical that we have more black people in the technology sector. As you all know, in the next 10-20 years, AI, machine learning, will be like just speaking English in this country or even the entire world. So the more we can have more black people in this field, the more we can

represent it in the products that are being built, and the more that our experiences are being influenced in every single product that these companies do build.

It's definitely critical that we have more black engineers, we have more black data scientists to do the analysis, and also just black data analysts to help tell the story that's more inclusive of our experience as well. It's definitely essential that we do have people from different backgrounds, colors, **creeds** to really understand data, and have the **alliance** to it, and tell the story, and make it very personal to our audience.